DLAC 2026 · BOOK STUDY · ATLANTA

Beyond the Chatbot

Stop talking about AI. Start building something.

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Four tools you can build this week. No coding degree. No new subscription.

1. **Scan** the code and pick a build.
2. Tap **Copy prompt + code**.
3. **Paste it into your AI** (ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot, or Claude). It walks you through the build one step at a time.

jharvey1113.github.io/beyond-the-chatbot

THE FOUR BUILDS

BUILD 1 · NO CODE · ANYONE

The Pocket Expert

A portable AI skill loaded with your standards, policies, and accommodation lists. One job, done well, in Gemini, ChatGPT, Copilot, or Claude.

Saves: answering the same 20 questions

BUILD 2 · TEACHERS · SPED

One-Click Parent Updates

Type a quick note next to each student, click one button, and every parent gets a personal email. Contact dates are logged automatically.

Saves: about 2 hours per round

BUILD 3 · OFFICE · DEPT. LEADS

The Sunday Night Briefing

Every Sunday at 6 PM, your team gets next week's IEPs, 504s, drills, and meetings in one clean email, pulled straight from the shared calendar.

Saves: "Nobody told me."

BUILD 4 · ADMIN · COUNSELORS

The Tiered Alert System

Attendance data sends the right email to the right people by tier and logs every contact. Starts in test mode, so families get nothing until you're ready.

Saves: catching kids at 5%, not 30 days

EVERY BUILD FOLLOWS ONE PATTERN

1 Get data · 2 Loop through it · 3 Check a condition · 4 Do something

The only difference between a tool for 30 students and one for 3,000 is more rows.

BEFORE YOU BUILD

- **Fake data first.** Test with your own email.
- **Describe the data. Never paste it** into a chat.
- **Always build a fail-safe:** "If not found, leave it for me."
- **Check district privacy & FERPA** rules first.

Your waste hunt. What three tasks did you repeat by hand last week? Circle the one that fits the pattern. That's your first build.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Platform heads-up: ChatGPT Custom GPTs are being replaced by Plugins (GPTs stop working Dec 11, 2026), and Gemini Gems are becoming Skills. Build 1 shows you how to make a portable skill that moves with you, plus a prompt to convert the GPTs and Gems you already have.

Beyond the Chatbot: Stop Talking About AI. Start Building Something. by James Harvey · ISBN 979-8250116329

Also at DLAC: **The Reality Gap**
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